

BEST BUY
digit
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Nikon S5
 Sleek looks, performs well!

finer detail on the paper clips, which was something the S5 missed out on. So we'll give the L-1 a slight lead here. If you like softer images, the S5 inches ahead.

The Premier DC8365 loses out a bit on clarity at the top end of its zoom, and this is clearly visible while viewing the test shots of each camera. It also loses out on specular detailing and colour reproduction. There were also noticeable grains when a photo is viewed at 100 per cent size.

The Samsung S-500 did reasonably well here, with overall good reproduction and colour rendition. It loses out slightly as far as detail goes; the image lacks that extra dash of crispness.

The Canon A530 loses out on some of the specular effects, which has to do with the fact that Canon models in general seem to produce a much softer set of colours than the other models here. Canons also typically perform less post-processing, meaning the results will always appear naturally soft, losing out on some of that aggressive sharpness. There were slight grains around some of the fruit photos, suggesting the camera has problems producing subtle variations in colour.

The Olympus SP-310 reproduces colours well, with good specular highlights, but misses out while highlighting finer details and textures.



The Decision Maker

Your Budget	You Need	We Recommend
Up to 8,500	Something small, not very complicated, that offers decent quality	Premier 5370, Premier 6370
Up to 15,000	High performance with a good price tag	Sony Cybershot DSC W-50, Nikon Coolpix S5
More than 15,000	High quality output and excellent detailing	Samsung S-800, Canon Powershot A700
NA	Something really compact without sacrificing on quality	Sony Cybershot DSC L-1, Nikon Coolpix S5
NA	Outdoor shooting capabilities with a lot of zoom	Canon Powershot S3-IS

noise, and artifacting of pixels. It's an unwanted element in digital photography.

The ISO Rating

This value represents the sensitivity of the image sensor to the light present in a scene. The higher this figure is (64, 100, 200, 400, 800 and higher), the better equipped the camera will be to take good photos in low-light conditions.

White Balance

White balance is a camera setting that can be tuned to adjust the tone of the colour in the resultant output. Its objective is to make the scene as neutral as possible as far as white goes, so white actually appears white without hues. Generally, without any white balance, white actually appears with hues; these depend upon the lighting conditions under which the white is viewed. For example, a camera will display a white object with different hues under yellow, fluorescent, or natural light. This is a naturally-occurring phenomenon that can spoil photographs with even the best cameras if the white balance is not set correctly. Cameras have settings such as Auto, Incandescent, Fluorescent, and more, for the white balance.